THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 09

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

When we think of a hero, we usually imagine someone in uniform or on a stage. Yet some of the bravest people do their work quietly. A nurse who stays beside a patient through the night, a teacher who stays after school to help a slow learner, and a farmer who walks miles to bring water to his animals all show a kind of courage that rarely appears on television.

Such people share a few qualities. They do their duty even when no one is watching, they put others' needs before their own comfort, and they do not expect applause. Their lives remind us that greatness is not a matter of size but of steadiness.

Everyday heroism seldom makes headlines. Consider the bus conductor who waits patiently for an old woman to board, the nurse who stays beyond her shift because a patient is frightened, or the boy who shares his lunch with a classmate who has forgotten his own. None of them expects a medal. Each simply sees a need and decides that it is theirs to meet.

What unites such people is a quality of attention. They notice what others overlook, and, having noticed, they do not look away. Courage of this kind can be learned, for it grows with practice, as a muscle grows with use. A student who chooses to speak up when a classmate is mocked is already walking the road that leads to larger acts of bravery. A society is made strong not by a few great heroes but by thousands of small, steady ones.

Schools could do more to recognise such quiet courage. Instead of honouring only the topper or the sportsman, an assembly might also thank the student who helped a new boy find his classroom, or the sweeper who quietly keeps the corridor clean. Such recognition tells children that goodness counts as much as achievement. It also tells them that heroism is within reach: it begins with noticing, continues with doing something small and becomes a habit. The hero, after all, is not someone unlike us but someone who acted when we merely watched.

We can learn from them in small ways. We can thank the sweeper who keeps our street clean, greet the watchman at the gate and help a classmate who is struggling. These acts cost nothing and take little time, but they tell people that their work is seen. A society that notices quiet heroes is a society that grows in kindness.

(i) The writer says that some of the bravest people: 1

(a) work only on stage **(b)** avoid duty
(c) do their work quietly **(d)** wear uniforms

(ii) Which of these is NOT given as an example of a quiet hero? 1

(a) A film star **(b)** A farmer **(c)** A teacher **(d)** A nurse

(iii) Quiet heroes share all of these EXCEPT: 1

(a) they do duty when unseen **(b)** they seek applause

(c) they put others first (d) they are steady

(iv) 'Greatness is a matter of steadiness' means: 1

(a) heroes are strong (b) nurses are great

(c) size is important (d) consistent effort matters more than size

(v) The writer suggests that we should: 1

(a) ignore small acts (b) thank those who serve us quietly

(c) wait for TV coverage (d) avoid new people

(vi) Give one example of courage that rarely appears on television. 1

(vii) Why do quiet heroes not expect applause? 1

(viii) Name two people whom the writer asks us to thank or greet. 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage meaning 'noticed' or 'observed'. 1

(x) What kind of society grows in kindness? 1

(xi) What unites the heroes mentioned? 1

(a) A military training (b) A quality of attention

(c) A love of medals (d) Great wealth

(xii) According to the passage, how can everyday courage be learned? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

A town's municipal board published the following information about its water supply. The town's population is about 1,20,000, and the daily demand is 18 million litres. The board, however, is able to supply only 15 million litres a day, drawn from a river 12 kilometres away and from twelve tube-wells. As a result, many colonies receive water for only two hours in the morning.

Source	Supply (million litres/day)
River	9
Tube-wells	6

To cut the gap, the board has decided to repair old pipelines, which at present lose almost one-fifth of the water through leaks. It has also asked residents to install meters and to avoid washing vehicles with running hoses. Housing societies have been encouraged to collect rainwater from rooftops, and a fine of ₹2,000 will be imposed on those who waste water.

The board's chairman said that the supply was expected to improve by December, when a new pumping station would start working. Citizens were asked to report leakage by calling the helpline number 1916, which functions twenty-four hours a day.

Environmental groups have welcomed the plan but have asked the board to publish a monthly report on the quantity of water saved, so that citizens can judge whether the promised improvements are really taking place.

(i) The town's daily demand for water is: 1

(a) 15 million litres (b) 18 million litres

(c) 6 million litres (d) 12 million litres

(ii) Water is drawn from a river that is: 1

(a) 2 kilometres away (b) 12 kilometres away

(c) 20 kilometres away (d) in the town

(iii) Old pipelines lose almost: 1

(a) half of the water (b) one-fifth of the water

(c) one-tenth of the water **(d)** all the water

(iv) The helpline functions: 1

(a) on Sundays only **(b)** from 9 to 5

(c) twenty-four hours a day **(d)** only in the morning

(v) How much water is the board short of every day? 1

(vi) Name two steps the board has taken to reduce the gap. 1

(vii) What will happen in December? 1

(viii) How much is the fine for wasting water? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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